

North West Resists Anti-Malaria Spray

Health authorities are battling more than rising malaria cases in the North West, as some communities push back against indoor residual spraying campaigns in what experts say may derail containment efforts



BONGANI MALUNGA

Communities in the Malaria-hit North West district have spurned the government's efforts to implement residual indoor spraying. The widespread resistance threatens to undermine the

North West District Council's target of fumigating 85 percent of households in the region as health authorities have reported 36 confirmed Malaria cases and one death in the district so far, raising concerns that the outbreak could escalate if preventative measures are not wide-

ly adopted.

COMMUNITY PUSH-BACK

Speaking during a press conference in Maun last Friday, the district council's Deputy Secretary for Primary Health Services, Dr Sandra Maripe highlighted that there has been a push-

back on the government's efforts to control the disease. Affected areas in the district include Toteng, Maun, Chanoga, Bodibeng, Sehithwa, Kareng and Legothwana.

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RESISTANCE

“A total of 964 people have refused to have their

homes sprayed. On top of that our majority challenge is that we find a lot of homes locked with nobody around especially in the Delta and Toteng. This also happened in Khwae, Mababe and Sankoyo villages where most people work in camps. A total of 2590 people were not at home while 1013 homes were locked with nobody at home at all. These are the challenges that stall our progress,” Dr Maripe revealed.

MISINFORMATION

Misinformation, fear of chemicals and a lack of community engagement have reportedly contributed to the pushback. The council is now considering intensified public awareness campaigns and engagement with traditional leaders to encourage households to participate in spraying programs. Experts warn that failure to achieve high coverage could reverse gains in Malaria control and place additional pressure on the already strained local health facilities.

LOW COMMUNITY COOPERATION

The situation in the North West district highlights the broader challenges faced by public health authorities in combating Malaria, especially in regions where community cooperation is low according to the council officials. Officials continue to urge residents to embrace preventive measures, stressing that collective action is vital to halting the spread of the disease and preventing further loss of life.

Meropa Rejects Worker Abandonment Claims

Meropa Resources has dismissed claims it left Masama Coal Mine staff behind to chase a new MMG Khoemacau Copper project

BONGANI MALUNGA

Meropa Resources has denied abandoning its workforce at Masama Coal Mine to pursue a new venture with MMG Khoemacau Copper Mine. The company insists it has consistently prioritised employee welfare, even amid financial strain caused by delayed payments from Minergy Coal.

Meropa Resources entered a five-year mining services

contract with Minergy Coal in December 2023, employing around 600 staff. While the project delivered 125 000 tonnes of Run of Mine and maintained equipment availability above 80%, Minergy Coal reportedly failed to meet its payment obligations, prompting Meropa to use bank facilities to pay salaries at year-end 2024.

PROACTIVE ENGAGEMENT

Despite ongoing non-pay-



ments between April and July 2025, Meropa claims that it engaged proactively with

the Botswana Mine Workers Union (BMWU) and government representatives to ex-

plore solutions, including potential retrenchment under the

Continues to page 15